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oct 10 - oct 17

presenting this week's TOP POSTs from

STACKER NEWS

Stacker News Zine
is created by
@plebpoet

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here

we tried to get an entire town to accept bitcoin ! 🇨🇷

8905 sats \ 22 comments \
@BullBitcoin_ 10 Oct bitcoin

How many shops can we get to accept Bitcoin in just 3 hours?
The Bull Bitcoin crew took over Santa Teresa, Costa Rica 🇨🇷

Two teams went head to head, using every trick in the book to orange-pill as many merchants as possible!
Can you guess how many said yes? 👀

13

total

lodging for wayfaring men book club: chapter 1

5194 sats \ 27 comments \
@Scoresby 10 Oct
BooksAndArticles

Welcome to the second week of our book club reading A Lodging for Wayfaring Men. We're reading one chapter every two weeks, so we are discussing Chapter 1 today. You can find the book club reading schedule here: #1582413

A Lodging for Wayfaring Men, Chapter 1

Out the gate, let's just accept that Rosenberg is pretty awful at writing. He may have an interesting story to tell, but his dialog is hamfisted, and the narration is frequently painful. For instance:

> "Somehow, the urgency in Frances' voice pushed Farber over the edge. She was desperate, violent, in her lust for knowledge."

It reads like a teenager's attempt to mimic Ayn Rand (who was pretty awful at prose herself) and is frequently so clumsy that it gets in the way of the story. The characters are constantly awash with an extreme sincerity that makes them feel like cardboard and Rosenberg indulges in a moral certainty that makes the characters even less believable.

If you can get past Rosenberg's delivery, there's an interesting question in this first chapter.

Our heroes seem to have started a parallel economy and the State is not too happy about it:

> "Our current problem is that technology has made it possible for average people to conduct business invisibly...What you don't know is that someone - and we don't yet know who - has set up a fully encrypted form of electronic cash."
> "We consider this an assault on the sovereign economy of the United States."

As is tradition, this parallel economy is initiated inside RPG of some sort, although Rosenberg doesn't give us many details about the game -- he's more interested in the grand plans of great people.

"Frances, did you ever really doubt that you were capable of doing great things?"

James Farber, one of the highly successful businessmen behind this parallel economy, is completely smitten with a journalist named Frances -- and God save us from such a romance: it's like a middle manager who tried to use a love scene as the central conceit of a powerpoint presentation on a sales company's mission and vision.

But, in the midst of it, Farber poses this question about greatness -- that not everyone is capable of it.

> "There are some of us who somehow escaped deep emotional scars, and who also had the right combination of genetics and circumstances that allowed us to do things of note...working hard to make something of yourself is a separate issue, as important and necessary as it may be. There are not many of us that have an operational ability to do great things."

Frances, of course, agrees, but, not being fully blinded by the light, she has her doubts:

> "James, I've always been told that thinking such things about myself would make me arrogant. Am I going to turn into a loudmouth braggart if I believe this?"

They certainly do come off as arrogant, which Farber acknowledges:

> "Most people hearing us talk like this would think that we are inherently superior or are lying to ourselves. Now the truth is that the only meaningful difference between us and many of those people is in our estimations of our selves. But getting people to believe that - to even consider that - is sometimes impossible."

Two decades after Lodging was published, it remains unfashionable to think that only some people are able to achieve greatness. We seem to much prefer to believe that it is a product of hard work, circumstances, and if you continue the list very long you end up with attributes that obviously only to some people. Our culture resists acknowledging that some people are much more effective than others.

But Farber holds it to be true, and because of that, he has a motto of sorts that he has relied on since he was a child:

> "That which I have seen and heard, I bear witness to.
> I believe my own senses. I believe my own mind."

One follows the other. If there are such people of greatness in the world, their most difficult struggle is succumbing to the pressure of the society around them and disbelieving the things their own mind tells them.

In the world of Bitcoin, it's often the case that what we have seen and heard -- how we understand the world with our own minds -- is at odds with most of the people around us. Many of us, it seems, lack no confidence in our worldview, and yet it has felt lately like their are chinks this armor of confidence.

Perhaps because number hasn't gone up enough and many of the free market experiments based on bitcoin (like Silk Road, Wikileaks donations, the Canadian trucker donations, and numerous privacy projects) have all bent the knee to the state. Bitcoin maximalism is out of fashion. Is this because it was wrongheaded or because we no longer believe our own minds?

Would Farber have been a toxic bitcoin maximalist?

comment

1334 sats \ 7 replies \ **@SimpleStacker** 10 Oct
I enjoyed the book at the start, but halfway through chapter 2 I'm questioning whether to continue.

As you said, the writing just feels a bit sophomoric. "Teenager's attempt to mimic Ayn Rand" is an apt description. I found it especially hammy how all the ladies got a description of their physical appearance, but none of the men did. The scenes with Farber and Frances are a bit hard for me to get through.

I can tell that he's pretty well steeped in Judeo-Christian theology though, as some of his references, including the title of the book, are pretty spot on. ...

[read-along] the odyssey, w.h.d. rouse, books i - iii

9858 sats \ 15 comments \
@billytheked 15 Oct
the_stacker_muse BooksAndArticles

Below I am starting the book club, as promised previously. It has probably taken longer than I originally led on. I expect that this can be forgiven. Whether you took up the challenge or not, there may be something for you in the following post. I have made an effort to give some original thoughts, followed by a character list and book summaries. As mentioned before, I am reading a hard copy of the translation of W.H.D. Rouse, but I can also recommend the digitized version of the translation of A.S. Kline.

leading themes and ideas

- post-war society leads to excess and decay
- culture, values, family, country -- all need to be defended by their inheritors
- the most commonly held belief is not always the correct one

Commentary

The first three books show how Telemachos has been living and responding to the apparent death of his father, Odysseus. Unbeknownst to Telemachos, his father is lost at sea, dealing with cyclops, and upsetting Poseidon in the meantime. With the help of other greek heroes (Achilles, Agememnon, Nestor, Menelaus etc.), Odysseus led the Achaeans to victory at the battle of Troy, and since then, things have not been going so well back home. This is the setup for the poem.

This is a story of what happens in the aftermath of war, when a great society produces heroes that defend its culture and norms against outsiders, and how, despite their victory on the battlefield, this same culture must be defended in their absence. This is seen at the outset, when the gods discuss what has become of the house of Atreus, whose son, Agememnon, finds himself the victim of Agisthos. The latter is eventually murdered by Agememnon's own son, Orestes, in an act of revenge for the murder of his father and the destruction of his household. Zeus laments the fact that, although they have brought this terrible fate upon themselves, men continue to hold Zeus to account. Wherever the fault lay, the poem tries to reckon with the phenomenon where society grows weak in the absence of the warriors who will defend their culture.

As the drama of the poem ensues, it is revealed how political infighting led the Achaeans to split up after Troy, leaving Agememnon and Odysseus away from their homeland. In the latter's absence, his wife Penelope and his son Telemachos have been left to defend what is left of his household. Suitors consume Odysseus' wealth, as they loiter, courting Penelope.

So far, I have taken the following from the poem, summarized in a few sentences:

- A great culture, such as the Greeks had, will produce great warriors, in whose absence its greatness will quickly fall to shambles.
- There will always be those willing to feast on the spoils bought by the sweat and blood of another person's brow
- Even when an entire population believe one thing, it may not be true. Truth is not easily discerned, but found out through persistence, struggle and adventure.

So, to you, reader of Epic poetry, I ask the question:

- Where do you see yourself on this cycle (i.e. good times --> weak men --> bad times --> strong men?)
- Is there an analogue in modern culture to the suitors feasting on Odysseus' wealth?

comment

126 sats \ 3 replies \ **@SimpleStacker** 15 Oct
Thanks for the summary. Reading your commentary, I was struck that the recent Christopher Nolan film didn't seem to convey that message. It did try to convey something about the deterioration of society, but I don't think it drew the line to the absence of strong men. That's not a preferred narrative of Hollywood, I imagine.

Reading notes:
key characters

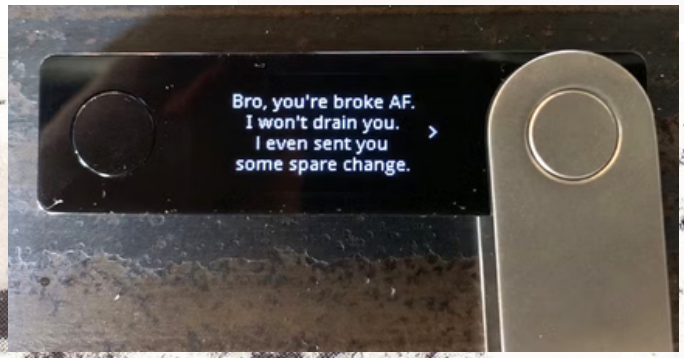
- Odysseys: a great warrior from Ithica. Never returned from the battle of Troy, in which he earned his stripes as a hero.
- Telemachos: the son of Odysseus.
- Penelope: the wife of Odysseus. Awaiting Odysseus' return.
- Suitors: men gathered in Ithica, enjoyers of Odysseus' house and belongings, as they vie for Penelope's hand in marriage.
- Zeus: Father of the gods. Feels let down by mortal men because of what happened in the aftermath of the battle of Troy concerning Agememnon.
- Aigisthos: killed Agememnon and married his wife. Is then killed by the latter's son, Orestes.
- Agememnon: in the aftermath of the battle of Troy, did not wish to sail home, for fear of displeasing Athena. He splits from Diomedes and Nestor, and stays in Troy
- Athena: Zeus' daughter. Favors Odysseus, intervenes for him so as not to see his house come into ruin
- Poseidon: god of the seas
- Mentes/Mentor: Athena in the form of a man, advises Telemachos in Ithica and in Pylos.
- Aigyptios: Wise councilman, blesses Telemachos
- Nestor: son of Neleus, king of Pylos.

...

meme monday - top meme goes in the newsletter

342 sats \ 4 comments \ **@sn** 12 Oct memes

89 sats \ 0 replies \ **@Satoshisatsamoto** 12 Oct



50 sats \ 0 replies \ **@curiousbitcoin** 13 Oct

sword < pen < home mining < high hashrate home mining

78.9k sats \ 33 comments \ **@jasonb** 16 Oct DIY
the_stacker_muse bitcoin

I really hope they don't have CCTV at Microcenter.

Clerk: Did you find everything you were looking for.
Me: Big time! This should complete a project I've been working on forever and am really excited about.
Clerk: How exciting! What's that?
Me: It's a tabletop bitcoin miner with the iconic, "This machine kills fascists," plaque from Woody Guthrie's guitars on it.
Clerk: OK sir, please don't kill people. Have a nice day.

Of course I'm sure they do have lots of CCTV at Micro Center, and of course I hope the kid working the register knew that Woody's statement on his guitar is just a variant of the, "The pen is mightier than the sword," maxim. I figured it'd be nice to step things up a notch and actually put it on a machine that literally makes it hard to control people.

My Bitaxe

A few months back, someone in the Heatpunks forum was generously giving away a faulty bitaxe. I jumped on the opportunity since this whole bitcoin thing has led to an obsession with tinkering. Most of my tinkering has been with industrial mining machines because I think if enough home miners start harvesting this trash, we'll end of with more decentralized network security. The bitaxes are great for learning, but i already had a few industrial machines and had learned a lot from them.

My free Bitaxe

My tinkering table:

It didn't have a barrel jack, so I ordered one online since it had become immediately apparent that the usb power couldn't hold the amount of amperage the unit needed. However, the manufacturer of this particular Bitaxe Ultra had used their own PCB and the barrel jack I ordered didn't fit. So I ran the spade connectors to a barrel-to-screw terminal.

Even with the barrel jack, I had to try three separate power supplies (the first died immediately and the second couldn't hold five amps like it said it could) before I was able to get the thing running.

My Guitaxe

So I figured, that this is *actually* stopping fascists from doing fascist things. Let's label it properly. I just threw some jumper wires between the machines and it's screen and was able to make this nice little facade for it.

I'm not actually a Woody Guthrie Fan

TLDR: I don't personally agree with Woody's ideology and don't dig his music. Feel free to skip ahead.

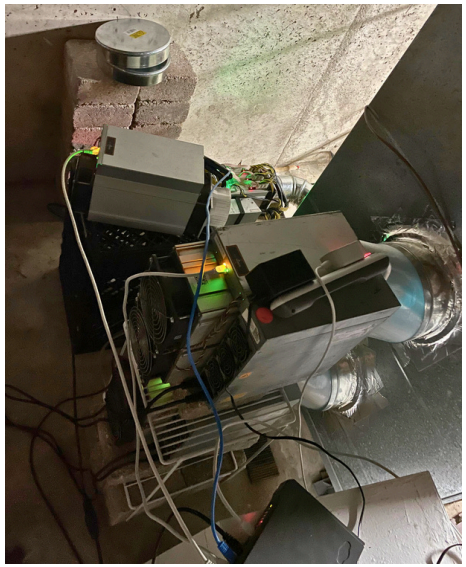
While I agree with his sentiment about fascists, Woody actually endorsed other types of authoritarianism, so I had to add a little to the statement so as to be perfectly clear. I figure, if you're going to alienate people, might as well make sure they're offended by what you *actually* are saying.

On top of that, I really don't like his music, except This Land Is Your Land, but that's mostly because of nostalgia. Nevertheless, I recognize the guy played a big role in shaping the American folk tradition, so this is a bit of an homage and critique/clarification at the same time.

continued

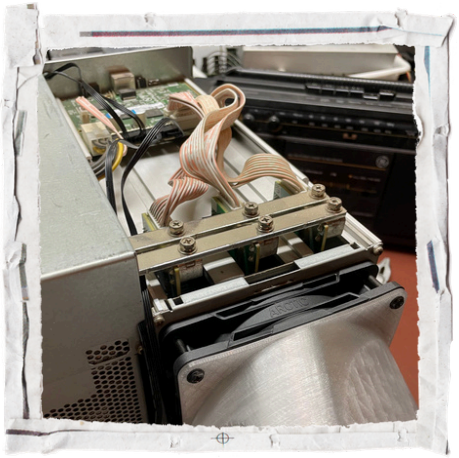
But does it scale?

So here is the state of my furnace at the end of last winter:



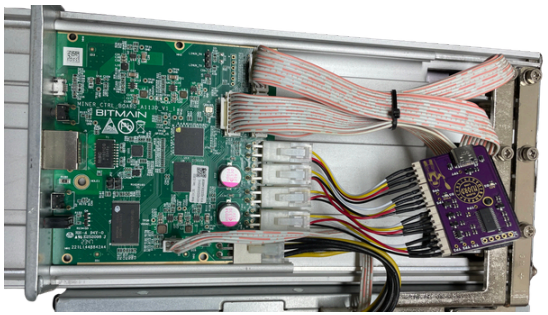
The above photos are P19 Pros. I got them in bulk for $3.50 a piece. They are slightly quieter, but definitely don't do any favors to the machine efficiency.

The primary issue was noise. So this year, I started off by seeing if cheap quiet fans could cut the muster.

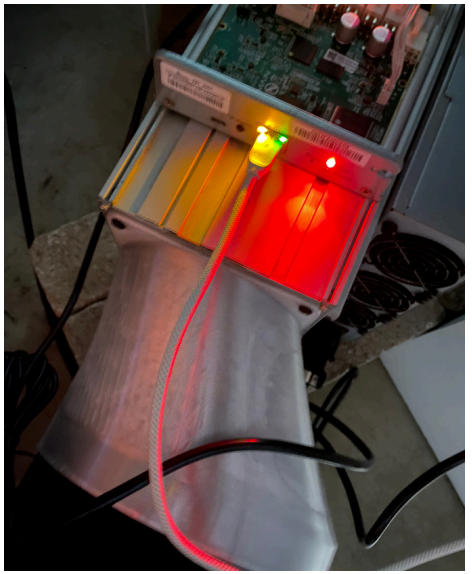


To Infinity and Beyond

So I finally bit the bullet and got a Njord board. Shout out to IxTech! I had been avoiding this route because, while not all that expensive if it worked, I wasn't confident I could pull if off. In that case, it was more expensive than I was willing to suffer through.



But I didn't take into account that the shroud I previously used to go into the furnace plenum was the **exact** size as the AC Infinity exhaust.



Now, I'm rocking with AC Infinity efficiency, the kids can play in literally the room next door without complaining about the noise, I'm figuratively "killing fascists and other tyrants", doing it in a way that becomes significant if it catches on with other folks, and writing run on sentences all day long.

If you made it this far, thanks for following along! Let me know if you want me to make some provocative 3d print for your home mining rig.

So, I figured since I had to make another shroud anyway, it was time to get Woody involved again.

comment

279 sats \ 2 replies \ **@billytheked** 16 Oct

Every man should have a tinkering table.

Ps. Decent bookshelf. **@denlillaapan** take note.

another day, another project

6849 sats \ 8 comments \
@samhainsam 16 Oct art tech BooksAndArticles

Hello frens!

How have you been? I hope you're doing good and are healthy wherever you might be.

They say idle hands are the devil's playground, and I have so many projects waiting for me but, like most people, not nearly enough time. But that's another conversation.

Anyway, I kept myself busy last week and this week too with a project I've been coming back to for quite a while. I'm so happy I finally made the time to make it real!

When I stumbled upon this project, I was very excited about it, Using NeoPixels with the Raspberry Pi. I thought, "Maybe instead I could make a sunrise lamp."

And boy, was it a journey.

Even before I started researching, I thought the best Raspberry Pi for such a simple project would be a Raspberry Pi Zero 2 W. Unfortunately, I couldn't find one, so I decided to go with the next best option especially since I was already brainstorming what else I could do with it besides the sunrise lamp. So I got a Raspberry Pi 3 B+.

Let me walk you through it.

First, it was a bit of a nightmare to install the OS. I don't know why I struggle with that part and with passwords. I type passwords the way R. L. Stine writes his stories: with just one finger. Either way, I finally managed to install everything and connect to the Wi-Fi.

I knew I would eventually need an electrolytic capacitor and one of those logic level shifters, but for the first trials—just trying to get the Pi and the LEDs working—I left those for later.

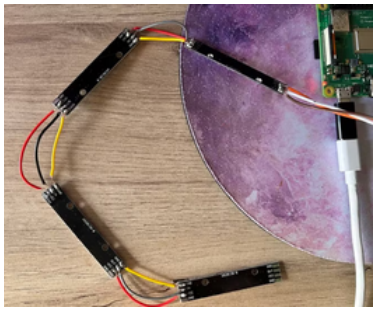
I also need a proper power supply for the LEDs themselves. I'm still not entirely sure, since it's only 32 LEDs, but we'll see. The preventive side of me will probably end up getting one anyway.

I had to test the first LED strip, but first I had to connect everything to the right GPIO pins and solder the wires. Usually my husband helps me with this part, but he only helped me with the first strip. After that, I was all on my own.

I didn't know soldering would be as challenging as stripping the wires, but once I got the hang of it, things went much more smoothly.

I did a lot of the research and troubleshooting myself, and for the scripts I also tried a bit of vibe coding. But hey, I was still the one soldering, wiring everything up, testing it, and figuring out what was going wrong. Then I ran the test and... it worked!

But then, of course, came the real challenge... soldering everything together! All the wires and the LED strips.



I had to use the headlamp I use when walking my doggie, and next time I'll definitely need a magnifying glass. I had to squint from time to time just to make sure I was soldering in the right place.

I managed to do the devil's work, I mean, my project, and then I used another script. But before that, I had to install Python in a virtual environment, because otherwise it wouldn't let me install rpi_ws281x.

It seems this way is easier to update and keep contained, and it doesn't affect the rest of the Pi. Also, this time I did everything directly in the terminal. I didn't use Thonny this time!

So many firsts with this project.

Anyway, in the end, my soldering and the script worked together beautifully!

A sunset right there just for me!

Throughout all this testing, I kept sniffing the Pi and the GPIO area from time to time, just in case I had connected something wrong. After all, powering the LEDs directly from the Pi could be too much for it.

Slowly but surely, I was able to turn the LEDs on and off first. Then I added the sunrise and sunset scripts.

keep reading online!